



# Ascentt

**EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK**

**07th November 2024 V 1.4**



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\*Any policy and procedure is subject to review and may be updated periodically to comply with applicable laws and regulations and to meet the needs of the company and its employees.



We are thrilled to have you join our Ascentt family and embark on this exciting journey with us. At Ascentt, we believe that our employees are our most valuable asset. We are committed to providing a supportive, inclusive, and dynamic work environment where everyone can thrive.

This handbook is designed to provide you with important information about Ascentt's policies, procedures, and culture. It will serve as a guide to help you navigate your way through your initial days and beyond. We value open communication, collaboration, and continuous learning.

We are committed to your professional growth and development and offer various opportunities for you to expand your knowledge and advance your career. We are confident that you will find Ascentt to be a rewarding place to work, and we look forward to seeing the positive impact you will make.

Once again, **Welcome to the A team!**

# WELCOME TO ASCENTT

**Mission Statement “We strive to be the Trusted Advisor on our client’s business problems by understanding the critical elements of their business requirements and providing innovative, affordable and sustainable technology solutions”**

### **Ascentt Core Values**

- Grow together, Teamwork and collaboration is the A team's mantra of success.
- Focus on value delivery. We measure success by the value delivered not billable hours.
- Customer focus. Drive execution and delivery with customer first mindset.
- Follow the seven principles of building trust.
- Continue learning and have fun while at it.

**We encourage you to embrace these values and contribute your unique skills and talents to help us achieve our goals.**

# **ASCENTT MISSION AND CORE VALUES**

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# EMPLOYEE CODE OF CONDUCT

## ASCENTT EXPECTS EMPLOYEES TO ACT WITH INTEGRITY, HONESTY, AND PROFESSIONALISM



**Integrity and Honesty** - Employees must conduct themselves with honesty and integrity in all Ascentt dealings, accurately representing their qualifications, skills, and experience; any form of misrepresentation, fraud, theft, or dishonesty is strictly prohibited.

**Professionalism** - Employees are expected to demonstrate professionalism in behavior, appearance, and communication, treating colleagues, clients, and stakeholders courteously and respectfully while avoiding behavior that could harm the company's reputation or working relationships.

**Compliance with Laws and Regulations** - Employees must comply with all applicable laws, regulations, and Ascentt policies.

**Confidentiality** - Employees must protect the confidentiality of Ascentt's information and the privacy of colleagues and clients, ensuring that unauthorized disclosure of confidential information is prohibited.

**Conflict of Interest** - Employees must avoid situations where personal interests could conflict with the interests of the company and disclose any potential conflict of interest to management.

**Use of Ascentt Resources** - Company resources, including time, materials, and equipment, should be used responsibly and for business purposes only, with personal use being minimal and non-interfering with work duties.

**Harassment and Discrimination** - Ascentt maintains a zero-tolerance policy for harassment, discrimination, and bullying, requiring all employees to treat others with dignity and respect, regardless of race, gender, age, religion, disability, or any other characteristic.

**Reporting Violations** - Employees are encouraged to report any suspected violations of this policy to their supervisor, HR, or through designated reporting channels, with retaliation against individuals who report violations in good faith being strictly prohibited.

**Disciplinary Actions** - Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment, with disciplinary actions determined based on the severity and nature of the violation.

Employees must adhere to this policy and report any violations, while managers and supervisors must lead by example, enforce this policy, and address any violations promptly; Human Resources must provide training on the code of conduct, handle reports of violations, and ensure fair enforcement of the policy.

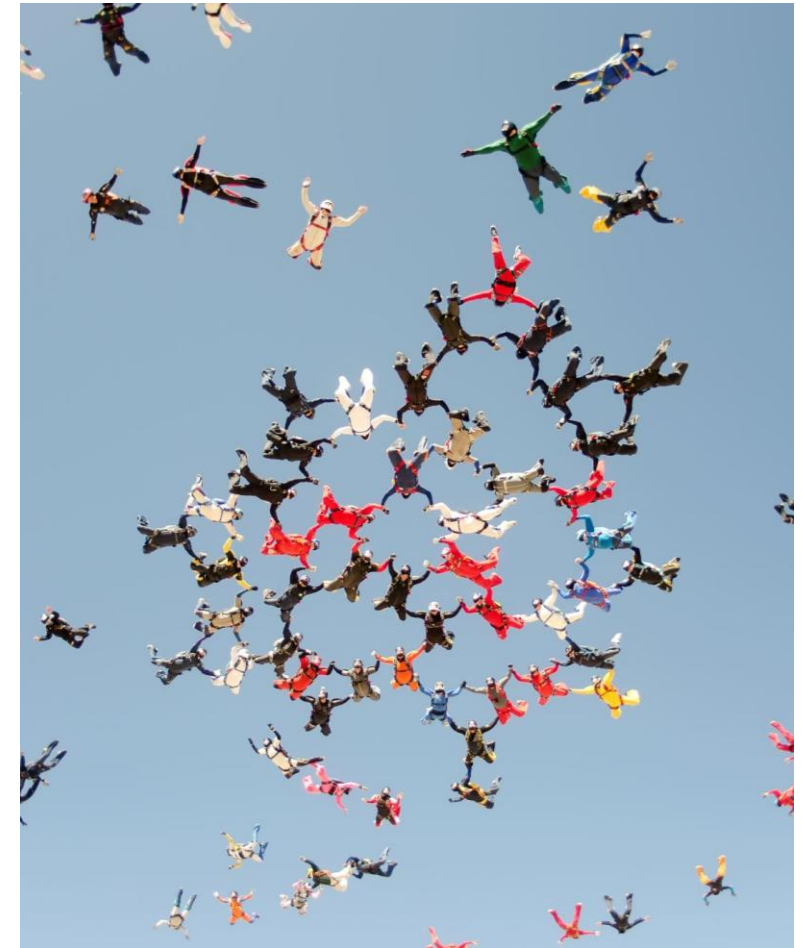
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# POLICIES & PROCEDURES



# Anti-Discrimination and Harassment Policy

- Ascentt prohibits discrimination and harassment based on race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, sexual orientation, gender identity, or any other characteristic protected by applicable law. This prohibition applies to all aspects of employment, including recruitment, hiring, training, promotion, compensation, benefits, discipline, and termination.
- Employees who believe they have been subjected to discrimination or harassment, or who have witnessed such behavior, are encouraged to report the incident immediately to the HR Team at [hr@Ascentt.com](mailto:hr@Ascentt.com). Reports can also be made through the Ascentt's grievance procedure. Ascentt will handle all reports with sensitivity and discretion, maintaining confidentiality to the extent possible. Retaliation against individuals who report discrimination or harassment or who participate in an investigation is prohibited and will result in disciplinary action.
- Ascentt will provide training and education to all employees.
- On the prevention of discrimination and harassment in the workplace. We are committed to complying with all applicable laws and will regularly review and update our policies to ensure compliance.





# ALCOHOL AND DRUG USE POLICY

Ascentt is committed to maintaining a safe, healthy, and productive work environment. The use of alcohol and illegal drugs, or misuse of prescribed medications, is strictly prohibited in the workplace.

## Prohibited Conduct:

- Use, possession, distribution, or sale of illegal drugs or alcohol on company and client premises or while performing company business offsite.
- Reporting to work under the influence of alcohol, illegal drugs, or any substance that impairs performance or poses a safety risk.
- Misuse of prescription or over-the-counter medications.

Employees must adhere to this policy and are encouraged to report any violations to their manager or HR.

- Managers and supervisors are responsible for enforcing this policy and taking appropriate action if violations occur.
- Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Ascentt encourages employees with substance abuse problems to seek assistance and happy to provide guidance as needed.



# LEAVE AND ATTENDANCE POLICY

## **Work Hours**

- Working hours will be based on client and project requirements and approvals from Reporting Manager & Project Manager.
- Under Special circumstances, an employee may be required to work in different work hours with a pre-approval from Reporting Manager & Project Manager.
- Employees are not entitled to get benefit in case of overtime.

## **Consequences of Attendance Issues**

- Failure to adhere to attendance and punctuality policies may result in disciplinary action, up to and including verbal warnings, written warnings and termination of employment.
- Disciplinary actions will be applied consistently and in accordance with Ascentt policies and applicable employment laws.

## **Flexibility and Exceptions**

- Ascentt recognizes that occasional exceptions to attendance and punctuality policies may be necessary due to extenuating circumstances. Employees should discuss such situations with their supervisor or HR department in advance whenever possible.

## **Paid Holidays**

- Detailed list of holidays is available with HR/Rippling. You can also subscribe to Ascentt holiday calendar every year.

## **Utilizing Leaves**

- The annual cycle for the purpose of leave will be from January to December.
- Employees must apply for leave in Rippling (<https://app.rippling.com/time-products/dashboard/time-off/>) and obtain the approval from the project manager & reporting manager.
- Unauthorized/unapproved leave will be treated as “Loss of Pay”
- During the time when employee is out of office, they should setup an away message in teams and mail which helps informing others about specific days when the employee will be out.
- Employees are expected to return to work at the end of their approved leave period and inform HR and their managers. If additional time off is needed, employees must contact their manager and HR department to discuss potential options.



# PATERNAL LEAVE - OFFSHORE

## a) Maternity Leave

- Eligible female employees who have completed 82 days of continuous service with Ascentt will receive maternity leave paid at 100% of their regular salary.
- Female employee can avail maternity leave up to 182 days up to two live births and can avail 12 weeks maternity leaves for the third and subsequent child. Maternity leave start on the day of delivery.
- Female employee can avail up to 6 weeks of maternity leave in the case of miscarriage or abortion .
- Commissioning mother or mother adapting baby with age of less than 3 months can avail 12 weeks maternity leave .
- Maternity leave cannot be carried forward or combined with any other leave.
- Employees should inform their manager and HR department of their intention to take paternity leave at least 60 days in advance, whenever possible and would require approval.

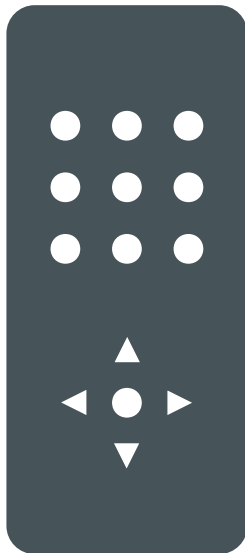
## b) Paternity Leave

- Eligible employees will receive paternity leave paid at 100% of their regular salary.
- Paternity leave is available up to 3 days of paternity leave within 3 months of the delivery date for up to two live births and will be paid 100% of their salary.
- Only employees who have completed one year of continuous employment with Ascentt Company are eligible for these benefits.
- Employees should inform their manager and HR department of their intention to take paternity leave at least 60 days in advance, whenever possible and would require approval.
- Start date or paternity leave will be determined in consultation with the employee, their manager, and the HR department, taking into consideration the needs of the business and the employee's preferences.

# OTHER PAID LEAVES - OFFSHORE

|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Annual Leave (AL)</b>           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Total 15 days leaves will be earned by employees during year. As AL is on Pro-rata basis, monthly 1.25 leaves will be accumulated to employee's account .</li><li>• AL is earned on a day-to-day basis. Employees do not earn AL when they are on Loss of Pay leave.</li><li>• Employee can accrue maximum 21 days AL per year.</li><li>• Maximum of 6 leaves can be carried forward at the end of year and remaining will be lapsed.</li><li>• Balance leaves can be cashed out at the time of separation.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Sick Leave (SL)</b>             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Employee can accrue maximum 5 sick leaves per year.</li><li>• Accrual clauses for new joinees are depending upon their joining date, which are as follows<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Joining date in Q1 of calendar year – 5 days</li><li>• Joining date in Q2 of calendar year – 4 days</li><li>• Joining date in Q3 of calendar year – 3 days</li><li>• Joining date in Q4 of calendar year – 2 days</li></ul></li><li>• Sick leave cannot be carried forward or cashed out.</li><li>• If an employee does not have enough sick leave available, it can be combined with annual leave.</li><li>• If both sick leave and annual leave are exhausted, the time off will be treated as unpaid leave.</li><li>• For sick leave exceeding one week, a fitness certificate is required upon returning to work.</li><li>• Employees must submit a medical certificate if taking more than 3 days of sick leave.</li></ul> |
| <b>Unpaid Leaves/Loss of Pay</b>   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• When PTO days are fully exhausted and used, an employee can take Loss of Pay depending on the situation and approvals from reporting and project manager. This should be discussed with HR beforehand and reported under Zoho.</li><li>• Employees must inform HR and their Reporting Manager when they plan to return to work and resume duties. Failure to do so may result in the initiation of termination processes.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Compensatory Off (Comp-Off)</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Ascentt is an entitled company, and employees are not entitled to receive compensatory time off. However, this can be discussed with your manager and team on a case-by-case basis to accommodate such requests.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

# REMOTE WORK POLICY



- Remote working arrangements may be considered on a case-by-case basis for employees whose job responsibilities allow for remote work without compromising client service, project timelines, or team collaboration. Eligibility will be determined by Ascentt HR Department in consultation with the employee's reporting manager, project manager and client manager.
- For all remote employees if you plan to work at another location other than your primary remote location more than a week, please take approval from your manager & notify HR.
- Ascentt laptops will be made available withing first 2 weeks based on the project requirement.
- Mouse and headsets will be provided along with the Laptop. No monitors and keyboards will be provided.
- Remote work hours in Offshore -
  - Establish daily overlap with US working hours to ensure effective communication and collaboration.
  - Set clear expectations with Ascentt Reporting Manager and Project Manager.
  - Prioritize scheduling meetings during the overlap period to maximize efficiency.
  - Balance your workload to ensure productivity during both India and US working hours.
- Remote employees are expected to maintain regular working hours as agreed upon with their manager. Availability during core business hours and for team meetings is essential to ensure effective communication and collaboration.
- Remote employees must maintain open communication with their team and colleagues through email, teams chat, and virtual meetings. Participation in team meetings and collaborative projects is essential for effective teamwork.
- Employees shall not use client laptops in public places with open networks and unsecured connections.

# ASSET USE AND LIABILITY AGREEMENT

Company-provided assets, including laptops, mouse, headphones, computer accessories, monitors, etc., remain company property and are intended solely for business use per company policy. Personal use is strictly prohibited.

**If assets are damaged due to my negligence, I agree to cover repair costs up to INR 80,000, which may be deducted from my salary or any final payments.**

## **My Responsibilities:**

- Asset Protection -- I will take all necessary precautions to protect assets from damage, loss, or theft and report any incidents immediately to IT or HR at [hr@ascentt.com](mailto:hr@ascentt.com).
- Repairs -- I will not seek repairs from external vendors and will only contact the HR/IT team for service needs.
- Return of Assets -- During absences of 15+ days, I will return assets unless approved otherwise. All assets must be returned in original condition upon employment end or when requested.
- Non-Compliance -- Failure to comply, including withholding assets upon departure, may result in legal action by the company.

# COMPENSATION STRUCTURE

- Ascentt has a dedicated structure in place which describes roles and bands for each level. It includes base pay, incentives, benefits, and other forms of compensation.
- Ascentt HR ensures that compensation remains competitive and aligned with industry standards.
- Salary is confidential & do not disclose



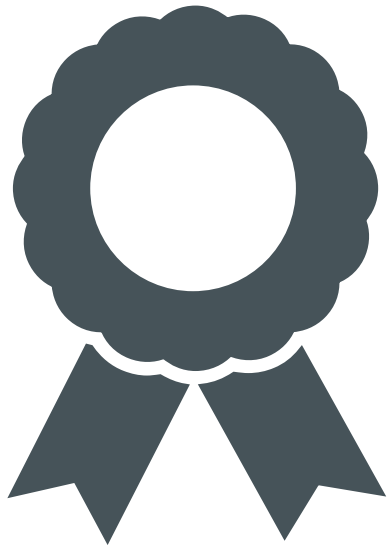


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# PAYROLL PROCESSING POLICY

- Ascentt processes payroll monthly. Direct deposit is available, and pay stubs are accessible through the employee portal – Paybook.
- In Offshore, all employees must submit accurate timesheets and leave approval by the designated deadline which is end of Friday of every week. All the approvals cutoff is Monday 9:00 am so it does not impact the payroll for them at the end of the month.

# BONUS AND INCENTIVE POLICY



- Ascentt recognize and reward employees for their contributions, achievements, and exceptional performance in support of organizational goals as part of the yearly performance evaluation program.
- Typically, it is after completing one year of your employment with Ascentt.
- Employee can receive an incentive or bonus as part of performance-based bonus, sales incentives, profit-sharing plans, recognition awards and referral bonus.
- Eligibility and criteria can vary based on job role, performance level, experience, years of employment with Ascentt, specific initiatives, project participation, and other factors. The criteria are clearly defined and communicated at the time of the evaluation process.
- Reporting Managers must provide feedback and support to help employees achieve performance goals.
- All incentive programs comply with all applicable laws and regulations. HR personnel receive training on legal requirements and best practices.
- Ascentt HR will continue to improvise the program cycle, feedback mechanism and criteria and adjust the policy as needed.
- Other benefits like 401K will only be eligible to employees after completing one year of employment with Ascentt.



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## SOCIAL MEDIA POLICY

- Ascentt encourages responsible use of social media that reflects positively on the company and respects confidentiality.
- As part of employment agreement, you are bind by NDA (non-disclosure agreement) Employees must not disclose confidential or proprietary information about Ascentt and Ascentt's clients on social media.
- Employees are expected to maintain a professional tone and avoid offensive or inflammatory content.
- As a fulltime employee with Ascentt, it is expected that your LinkedIn represent the same – not your previous company or client company.
- Be mindful about social media usage during working hours as it can affect productivity.
- Violations may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

# EMPLOYEE REFERRAL POLICY

- Ascentt offers bonuses for referring qualified candidates who are hired and retains with the company for a period of at least a month.
- The employee referral is payable after 3 months of the candidate's joining.
- The referral bonus is depending on the position of candidate
  - Entry level Position – 2 yrs to 4 yrs- 15,000/-
  - Mid Level Position– 4 yrs to 7 yrs – 25,000/-
  - Senior Level Position – 7+ yrs – 30,000/-

Please be mindful of who you recommend; it should be a candidate you believe can fit into the Ascentt culture and whose genuine experience you can vouch for



# REIMBURSEMENT POLICY

- Ascentt employees are eligible for reimbursement of reasonable and necessary expenses incurred during work, including client entertainment, travel, and training expenses. All expenses must be pre-approved by the employee's manager to qualify for reimbursement.
- When submitting any expense for reimbursement, please ensure it includes the date, purpose, attendees, itemized receipt, and proof of payment.

## General guideline on expenses

- The expenses should be preapproved from management.

## Training Expenses:

When submitting training expenses, include all relevant details, dates, receipts/invoices, proof of payment, and completion certificates if applicable. Also, attach the approval email from your manager.

## Submission Process and Timeline:

- **Timeline to Submit: Within 30 Days:** Employees must submit their reimbursement requests within 30 days of incurring the expense.
- **Quarterly Cut-off:** Expenses submitted after the quarterly cut-off may be processed in the next quarter.
- **Details to Submit:**
  - **Expense Report Form:** Complete the standard expense report form with personal details, date of submission, and a detailed description of each expense.
  - **Receipts:** Attach itemized receipts and proof of payment for all expenses.
  - **Pre-Approval Documentation:** Attach any email approvals or pre-approval forms from your manager.

## Submission Method:

Claim expenses and attach expense report form and supporting documents on paybook.



Ascentt termination policy outlines the procedures and guidelines governing the termination of employment at Ascent and ensuring consistency, fairness, and compliance with legal requirements in all termination scenarios.

**Voluntary Termination:**

- Employees are encouraged to provide 3 months notice in writing.
- Employees will be notified of approval and acceptance of the resignation via email, outlining the effective date.
- An exit interview may be conducted to gather feedback and facilitate a smooth transition.
- Employees are required to return all Ascentt and Ascentt's client property, including but not limited to laptops, access badges, and any confidential information.
- Final Compensation details regarding final pay, benefits, and any severance packages will be provided in accordance with applicable laws and Ascentt policy.

**Involuntary Termination:**

- When an employee consistently fails to meet performance expectations despite coaching and performance improvement plans.
- Violation of Ascentt policies, including but not limited to harassment, discrimination, dishonesty, theft, or substance abuse.
- Layoff or reduction in force due to business necessity.
- Severance packages may be offered based on length of service, job level, and other criteria.
- Terminations will be conducted in compliance with federal, state, and local employment laws.
- It is expected to maintain confidentiality regarding the circumstances of the termination.
- Any disputes arising from the termination will be handled through the Ascentt's grievance and dispute resolution procedures.

Ascentt HR can help guide with resources and guidance to assist with job search, unemployment claims, and other post-termination matters, if needed.

# TERMINATION POLICY

# CONFLICT RESOLUTION PROCESS

## Procedures:

- Informal Resolution: Employees are encouraged to resolve conflicts informally, seeking guidance from supervisors or HR if needed.
- Mediation: Mediation, facilitated by HR, offers a confidential forum to resolve conflicts voluntarily and effectively.
- Formal Resolution: If informal methods fail, formal resolution involves structured investigation and appropriate actions based on findings.

## Clauses:

- All parties involved must maintain confidentiality throughout the process, except where necessary for investigation.
- Ascentt prohibits retaliation against employees involved in conflict resolution processes.

## Training and Awareness

- Skills: Training provided to enhance conflict resolution skills and prevent escalations.
- All employees are expected to comply with conflict resolution policies.

# GRIEVANCES PROCESS



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# DISCLAIMER

The handbook provides guidance and information but does not constitute a contract or alter the at-will employment relationship.

Employment at Ascentt is at-will, meaning either party may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause or notice.

Ascentt reserves the right to update, revise, or modify policies and procedures in the handbook as needed. Employees will be notified of changes, and consultation with HR is available for clarification. These policies will be reviewed periodically to ensure alignment with current laws and best practices



**Employee Sign:**



**Employee Name:**



**Date:**

**ACKNOWLEDGEMENT**

I have received the Offshore\_Employee Handbook, and I understand that it is my responsibility to read and comply with the policies contained in this document.

Abhishek Saxena

*Abhishek Saxena*

12/29/2025